RIOT

LESSON 1: Embrace the Power Within You

LEARNING INTENTIONS	SUCCESS CRITERIA
Students will: • Understand our school's reasons for undertaking RIOT. • Know a definition of wellbeing, and resilience. • Understand how anxiety can develop.	Students will be able to: • Explain why their school is doing the RIOT project. • Give a definition of wellbeing and resilience. • Explain how anxiety can develop over time.

INTRODUCTION TO R.I.O.T

This series of lessons is not about creating a perfect world where there'll be no stress or anxiety. It's not about controlling the world; it's about controlling our preparation for life's events and our self-management when they occur. We are working to increase our coping capacities so that we manage the regular stresses of life and school enough to do well, keep going, and be reasonably happy and content.

EXERCISE WELLBEING

The World Health Organisation (WHO) defines mental health as a state of wellbeing that enables a person to cope with the stresses of life, realise their abilities, learn and work well, and contribute to their community (2022).

What does mental health mean to you? How do you know you are in good mental health?

What are the signs that someone is looking after their mental health?

Wellbeing can include

- Positive emotions and gratitude
- Relationships and empathy
- Accomplishment and optimism
- Engagement and mindfulness
- Meaning and purpose
- Health and strengths

Can you think of anything that is missing from this list?

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PROMOTING RESILIENCE SKILLS IN TEENAGERS

EXERCISE RESILIENCE

What is your understanding of resilience? What are some words or phrases that are connected to the idea of resilience?

Around the roots, write in some of the things that could make your roots stronger and make you a more resilient person.





Look at the above diagram.

Aspects of resilience I'm good at.

_____

_____

Aspects of resilience I might need to work on.

_____

_____

- Resilience is buildable and constructible.
- The skills the young person practises can help that construction to occur.
- Seemingly modest things, repeated over time, have the biggest effects.

EXERCISE BRAINSTORM

Brainstorm what it would be like if you didn't have resilience.



Not all, but a significant part of being resilient is learned. It's the same with anxiety. Often the way we respond to stress is 'habit-driven' and sometimes those habits aren't helpful. If necessary, our habits can be relearned. Psychologists who work with teenagers use a process called 'cognitive restructuring' (changing the way they think) to help them build up their resourcefulness to manage adversity.

LESSON 2: R.I.O.T

LEARNING INTENTIONS	SUCCESS CRITERIA
Students will: • Understand the RIOT goals and limitations. • Understand the expectations for students. • Be able to discuss how some well known people dealt with adversity. • Know about locus of control and circle of control.	Students will be able to: • Explain the expectations teachers' have of students. • Outline how two well known people dealt with adversity in their life. • Be able to identify internal locus of control and external locus of control thinking. • Complete a circle of control diagram.

EXERCISE LOCUS OF CONTROL

Locus of control is the degree to which people believe they have control over the outcomes of their lives. Individuals are somewhere on the continuum.
An **internal locus of control** means you believe your own actions, efforts, and abilities determine events.
An **external locus of control** means you believe external forces like luck, fate, or other people are responsible for what happens.
Resilient people are more likely to cultivate an internal locus of control.

Complete this table.

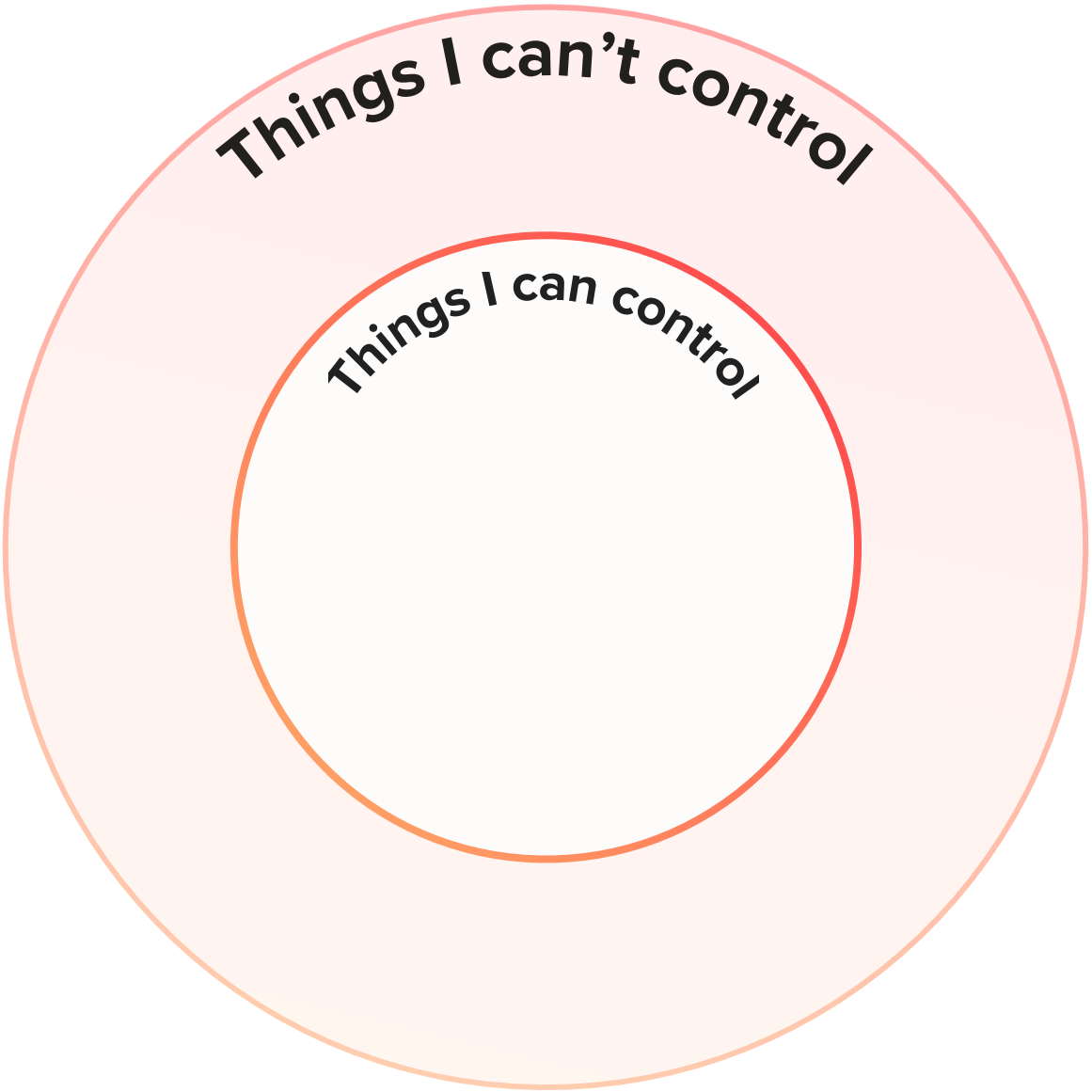
Statement	Internal (I) or external (E) locus of control
Our team lost because our defence wasn't strong enough. We need to work on this in training.	
I got a B on my Science test because I reviewed the topic questions.	
I only got a C for that assessment because Ms Sampson doesn't like me.	
I didn't get into the basketball team because I'm unlucky.	
I was selected for captain because I am committed and I treat all team members with respect.	
I can't go on the excursion because Mr Cross wouldn't take my late permission slip.	

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EXERCISE CIRCLE OF CONTROL

Complete the circle of control - things I can't control, things I can control.



There are numerous things that are beyond the control of a young person, or any individual, such as the family you are born into, your genetics, where you are born and grow up, the weather and laws around driving, drinking or aggressive behaviour.

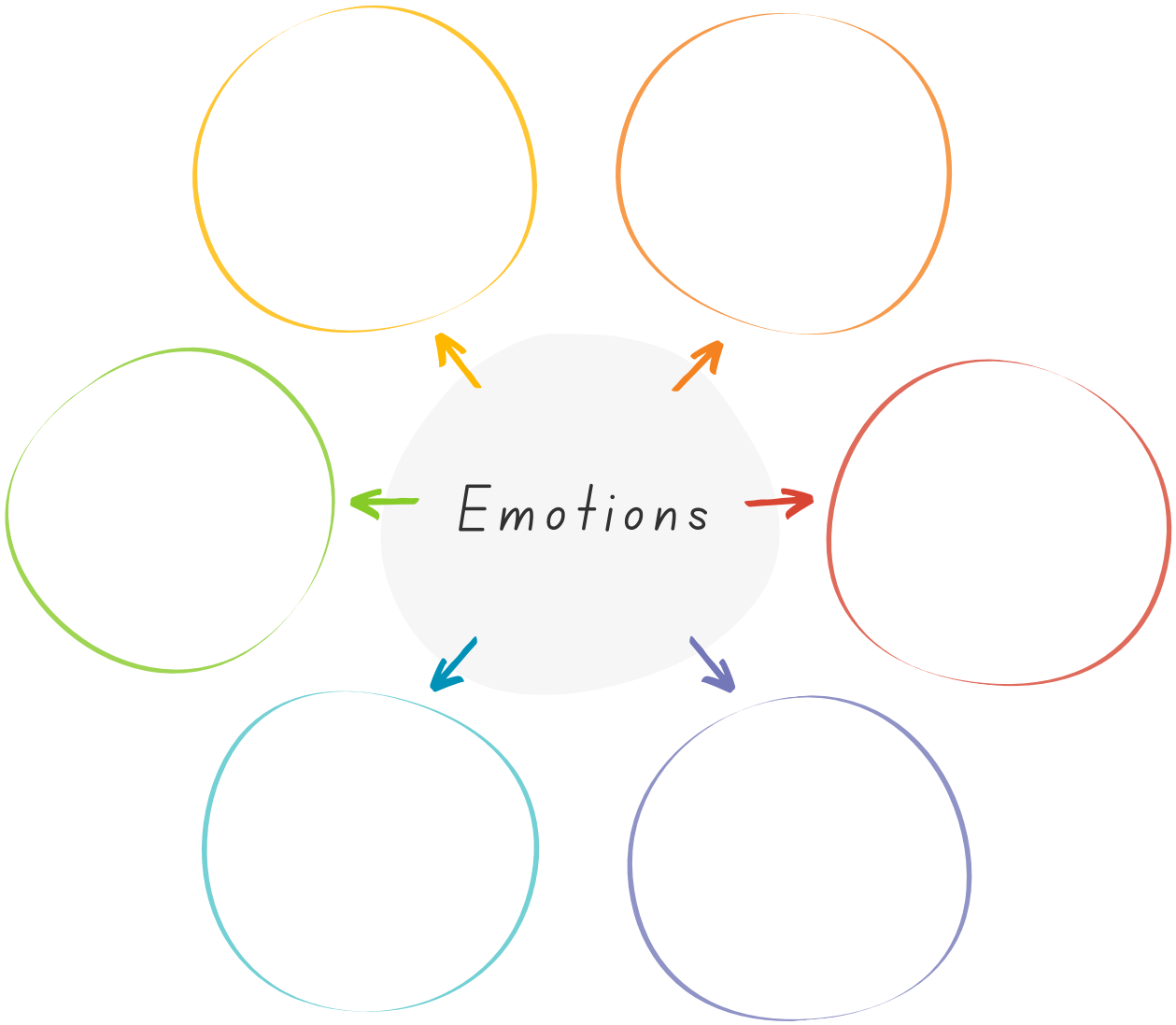
But there are aspects of life that a young person can take some control over. Recognising this means that you can put your effort into the aspects of life where you are most likely to be able to have some effect.

LESSON 3: Managing Feelings, Managing Stress

LEARNING INTENTIONS	SUCCESS CRITERIA
Students will: • Learn that labelling feelings is a first step to managing them. • Understand some of the challenges facing adolescents. • Understand the metaphor of the stress bucket.	Students will be able to: • Name a range of feelings. • List some of the challenges faced by young people and the strategies that help. • Complete the stress bucket diagram.

EXERCISE EMOTIONS

Brainstorm as many emotions as you can in 60 seconds.



Why do you think it is important to have the vocabulary to talk about emotions?



Our brains are wired for negative thoughts

Negative views tend to stick and be hard to change. It takes effort to see the 'upside' of things. You can develop habits that train your brain and mind to focus on the positive aspects of your life.

Remember, emotions are not permanent - they come and go. We do not need to act on every emotion. We can just observe our emotions and remind ourselves that they will change and fluctuate.

REFLECTION HOW HAVE YOUR FEELINGS CHANGED OVER TIME?

Can you remember some of the feelings you had when you were 5 years old? Can you name 3 of them?

What emotions are you mainly experiencing at this time of your life? Can you name 3 of them?

Stress Bucket

We can all feel a bit 'off' sometimes.

It's normal to feel stress in certain moments, but when these feel overwhelming it can begin to affect your day-to-day wellbeing.

Doing this activity can help you to explore the things that make you worried and think about ways to release these before it all gets a bit much.

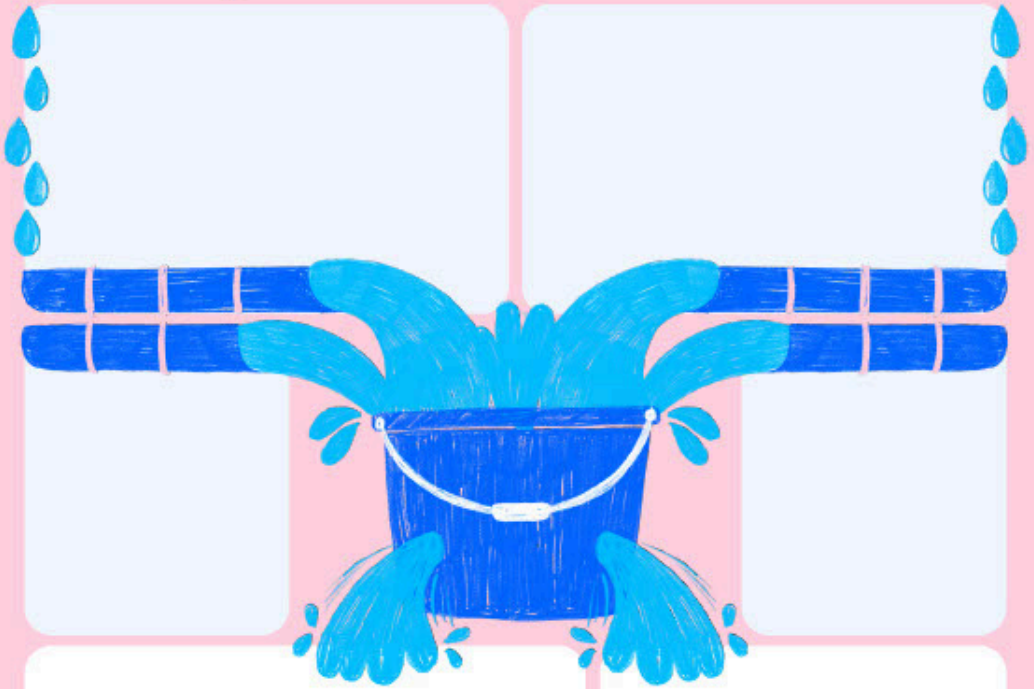
1 In the boxes with water going in to the bucket, write down or draw things that make you feel worried or panicky.

This could be things like: not getting enough sleep, having an issue with a friend or too much homework or coursework.

2 In the boxes with water going out of the bucket, write down or draw things that help you to release these pressures and worries. Sometimes it's good for adults in your life to know these, so they can support you with feeling more like yourself again.

This could be things like: talking it through with friends, going to the gym or chilling with pets.

The things that make me feel worried or panicky...

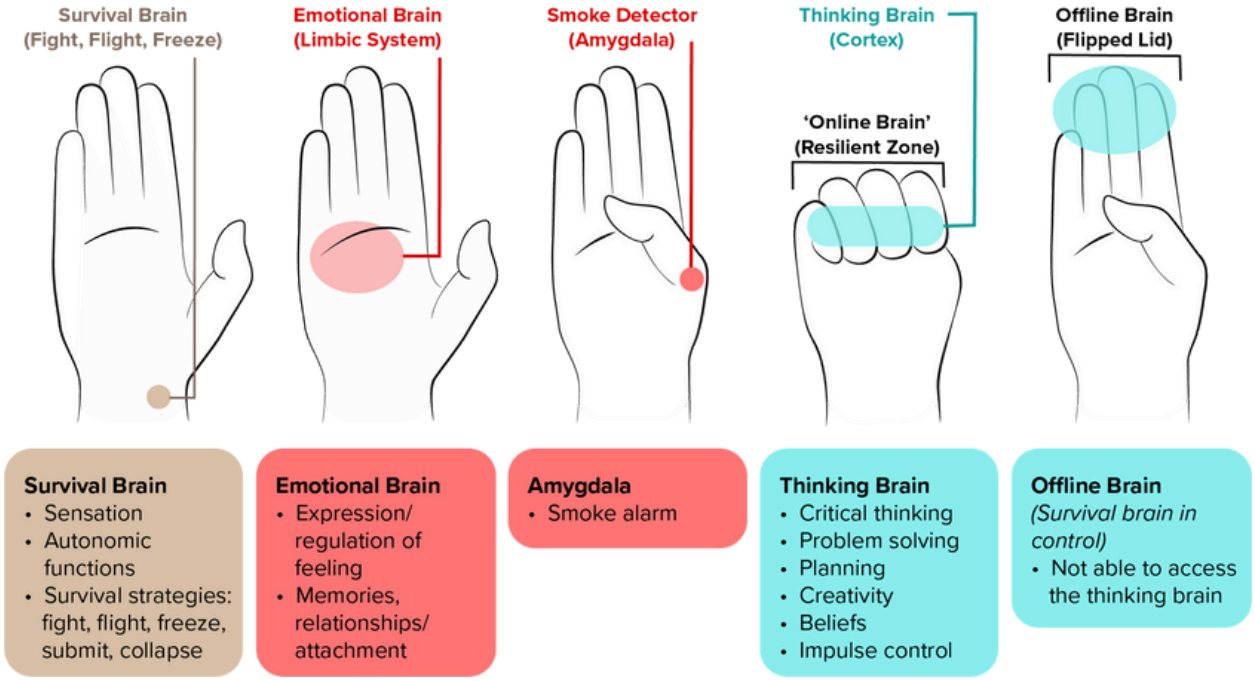


The things that help me release these...

YOUNGMINDS

LESSON 4: The Amazing Brain

LEARNING INTENTIONS	SUCCESS CRITERIA
Students will: • Learn that different areas of the brain have different functions. • Understand that the adolescent brain is still developing. • Learn the difference between a reaction and a response.	Students will be able to: • Name the three main sections of the brain that contribute to anxiety. • Be able to name and practise at least two calming strategies. • Be able to identify internal locus of control and external locus of control thinking.

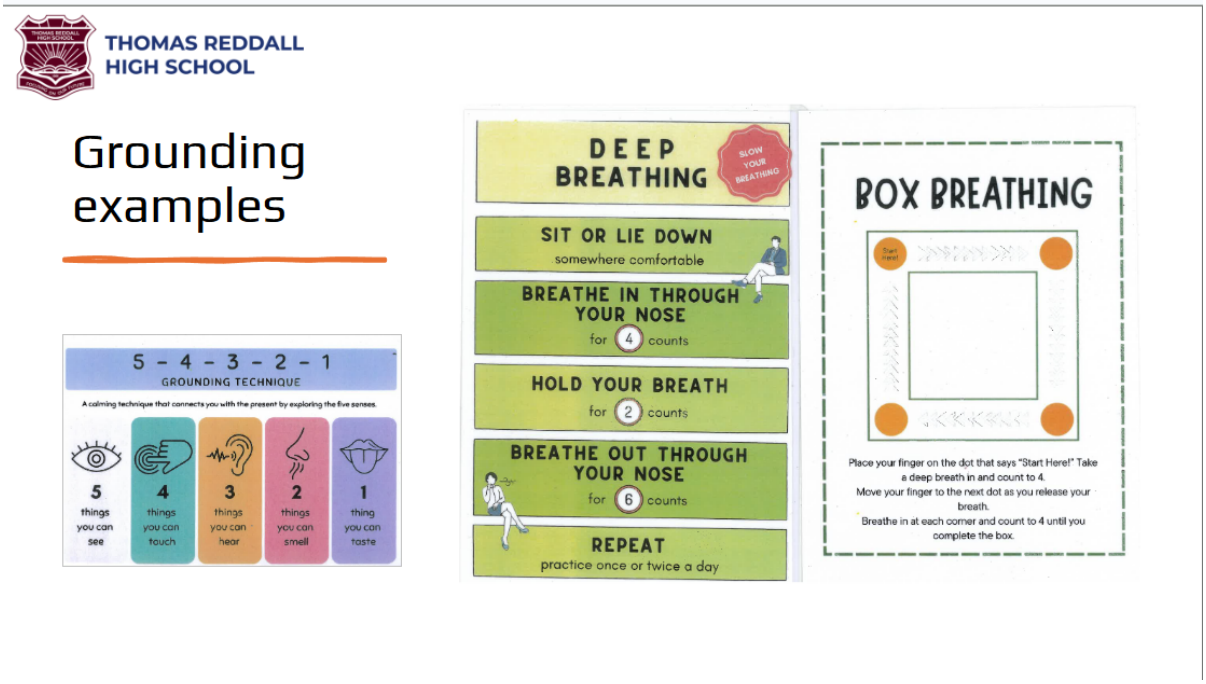


EXERCISE FIGHT, FLIGHT OR FREEZE

What can happen to our body during the fight, flight or freeze response?

Think about a time when you were in 'fight, flight or freeze' mode. What did you do? How did you return to calm?

PRACTISE GUIDED MINDFULNESS



It is important to practise these skills when we are not in a crisis moment so that when something happens and our amygdala is firing, we can easily draw on the skills to calm ourselves down.

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EXERCISE PLAN IN MY POCKET



Some things that make me feel anxious are...

1. _____
2. _____
3. _____

When I feel anxious:

I feel this in my body...	I have these thoughts...	I do these things...



RELAXATION SKILLS

- ☐ Take 3 deep breaths
- ☐ Get a hug or give a hug
- ☐ Practice mindfulness
- ☐ Tense and relax your muscles
- ☐ Take a nap
- ☐ Other: _____
- ☐ Other: _____

DISTRACTION SKILLS

- ☐ Count from 1 to 100
- ☐ Find a trusted person to talk to
- ☐ Watch a funny movie
- ☐ Listen to music
- ☐ Do a hobby, write, draw, color, build
- ☐ Other: _____
- ☐ Other: _____

MOVEMENT SKILLS

- ☐ Take a break in your safe place
- ☐ Exercise/Run/Jog
- ☐ Jump up and down
- ☐ Stretching
- ☐ Yoga poses
- ☐ Other: _____
- ☐ Other: _____

THINKING SKILLS

- ☐ Use encouraging self-talk
- ☐ Think of 3 things you are grateful for
- ☐ Think of a peaceful place
- ☐ Challenge unhelpful thoughts
- ☐ Imagine sending your worries away on a rocket
- ☐ Other: _____
- ☐ Other: _____



LESSON 5: Faulty Thinking and What to do About it

LEARNING INTENTIONS	SUCCESS CRITERIA
Students will: • Understand different kinds of faulty thinking. • Learn some strategies for countering faulty thinking. • Recognise that we can develop unhelpful patterns in our thinking.	Students will be able to: • Identify and explain at least three kinds of faulty thinking. • Explain the link between an event, our interpretation and an emotion. • Challenge faulty thinking by 'Taking a thought to court'.

EXERCISE COGNITIVE DISTORTIONS OR FAULTY THINKING

Give an example of each of these common cognitive distortions.

Emotional reasoning

Discounting the positive

Mind reading

All or nothing thinking (black and white thinking)

Catastrophising

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EXERCISE SCENARIOS

Identify the faulty thinking in these scenarios

Scenario 1 - Claude

Claude's teacher is walking around the classroom checking on student work and Claude has his emails open. The teacher asks Claude to get back to their classwork, without realising that Claude was getting a link to the shared research document from his research partner. Claude decides then and there that the teacher hates him.

Claude's faulty thinking

Scenario 2 - Sara's dad

Sara's dad is waiting for her to get home from a party. She is being driven by a friend who he knows, but not very well. The agreed curfew is 11pm and it's now 11.30pm and they're still not home. Sara's dad starts panicking and assumes that the kids have been in a car accident.



Sara's dad's faulty thinking

What cognitive distortions or faulty thinking are you most likely to fall into?

What factors are likely to make challenging your own faulty thinking more difficult? (Factors like being tired, the influence of others, low mood etc.)

TURNING NEGATIVE THOUGHTS INTO POSITIVE ONES

I can't do this	I can do this because I've done something similar before. I can do this because I've learnt new things before.
I always make mistakes	If I make a mistake, I can try again. Mistakes are an opportunity for learning and improving.
I'm bad at Maths/ English/Writing/ Science etc	I can get better with practice. I don't have to be great at everything, I just need to try my best.
I'm never going to finish this	I've finished tasks like this before. I need to focus on completing one part at a time.
I don't understand this	This is an opportunity to learn something new. If I take my time and go over it, I'll get it.
My brain just can't think straight!	I'll take a break and then tackle it from a new perspective.
This homework is so boring!	I might find this a bit boring but I'll have it done soon. Sometimes repetition is a good way to learn things.
I never do things right	It's hard to get things right on the first go but, with practise, it will get easier.
If I ask for help, my teacher/other students will think I'm dumb	I don't think other students are dumb when they ask for help. Some other students probably have the same question.

Write 3 more negative thoughts and turn them into positive ones.

1. _____
2. _____
3. _____

LESSON 6: Facing Our Fears

LEARNING INTENTIONS	SUCCESS CRITERIA
Students will: • Learn strategies for facing fears. • Know how and when to implement arousal reduction techniques to lower the fear response.	Students will be able to: • Demonstrate some arousal reduction techniques. • Complete an exposure ladder.

EXERCISE FEARS

What are some common fears that some people have?

EXERCISE EXPOSURE LADDERS OR 'HAVE A GO' LADDERS

Exposure ladders are a common technique used to help someone gradually face a fearful situation. It needs to be done in a structured and careful way, setting the person up for success at each step. The time spent on each step will vary and a person will need to draw on the skills they have learnt to calm their limbic system (box breathing, grounding, visualisation etc.).

Here's a sample 'Have a go' ladder.

Goal: Riley would like to improve his social skills

Step	Situation	Fear Rating
8	Approach a classmate during break and ask if he can join in their game.	10
7	Watch a game at break time and speak to someone else who is watching.	8
6	While waiting to go into class, ask someone about their weekend.	7
4	Ask a classmate a quick question (e.g. Is the Maths quiz this Friday?).	6
5	Make a a comment to a classmate (e.g. Have a good weekend.).	5
3	Make eye contact and say 'Hi' to one person he knows in every lesson and in a break time.	4
2	Make eye contact and say 'Hi' to one person he knows every day.	3
1	Practice saying 'Hi! How are you?' with a friend.	2

Create your own 'Have a go ladder' for a fear or a problem you would like to deal with.

If you can't think of one of your own, try one of these:

- Noah is too nervous to give a talk in front of the class.
- Evie is so afraid of bees, she won't do sport on the oval.
- Claudia hates eating in front of people so she usually eats nothing at school.

Have-a-Go Ladder

Goal: _____

Step	Situation	Fear Rating	Date Achieved

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EXERCISE FACING FEARS

What are some short term (say, over the next 6 months) consequences of <u>not</u> facing my fears?

What are some long term (the rest of my life) consequences of <u>not</u> facing my fears?

What are some short term (say, over the next 6 months) benefits of facing my fears?

What are some long term (the rest of my life) benefits of facing my fears?

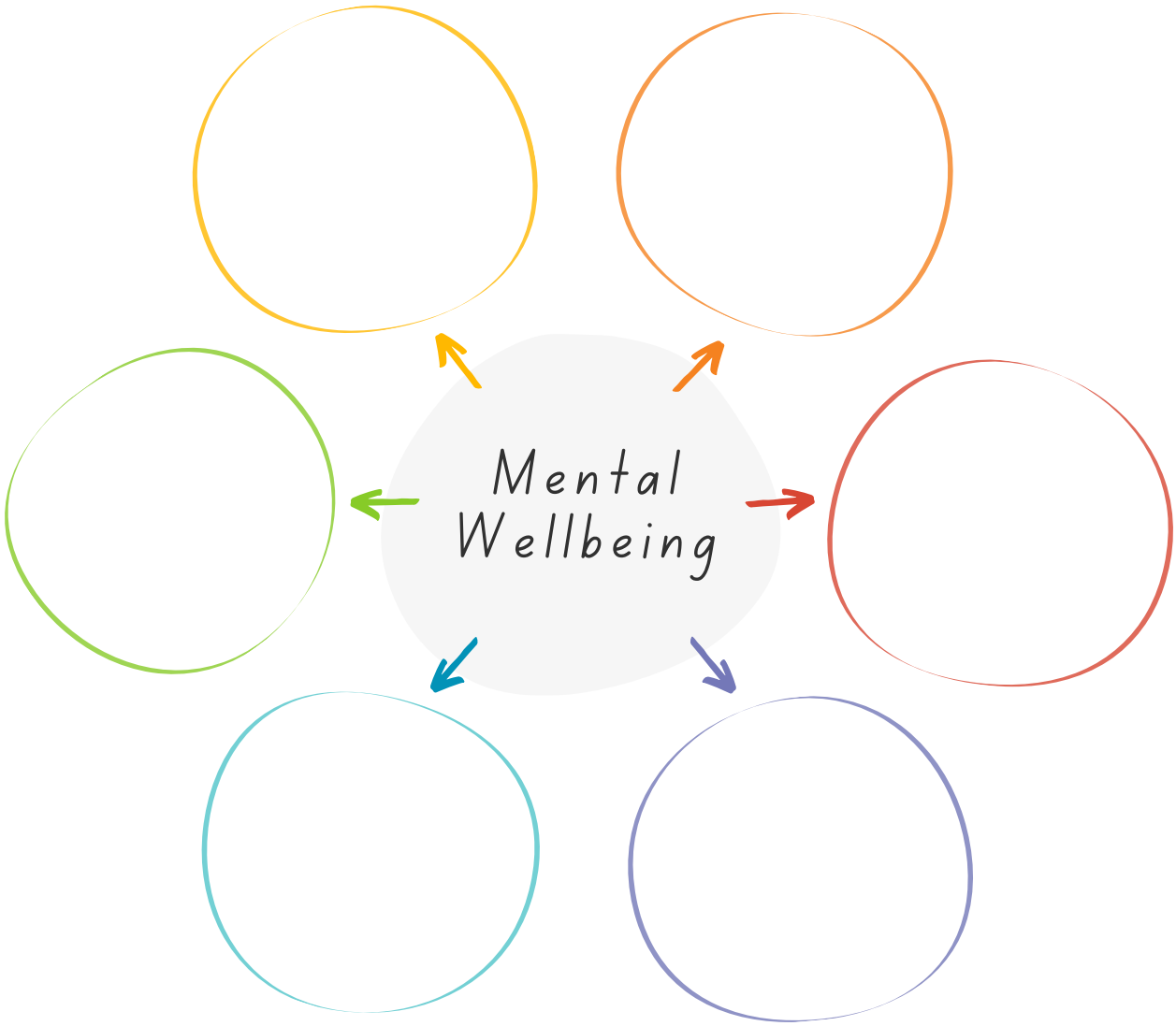


LESSON 7: Mind Maintenance

LEARNING INTENTIONS	SUCCESS CRITERIA
Students will: • Learn strategies for maintaining their mental wellbeing. • Understand the importance of mental wellbeing in managing stress and emotional overload.	Students will be able to: • Set up some mind maintenance routines.

EXERCISE MENTAL WELLBEING

Brainstorm some factors that contribute to our mental wellbeing.



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EXERCISE MENTAL WELLBEING

Here are six factors that contribute to our mental wellbeing.

- Sleep
- Exercise
- Social engagement
- Limit unhealthy screen time
- Relax and recharge
- Healthy eating

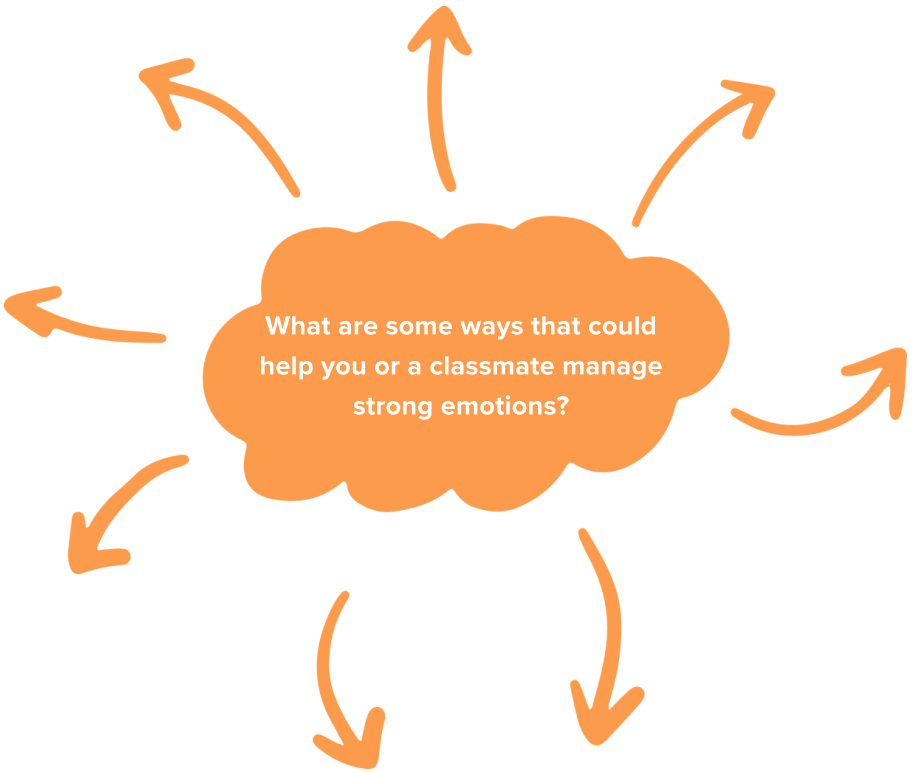
Can you think of any other important factors we should add to this list?

Give yourself a rating from one to five stars for how well you think you are managing each factor. Colour the stars.

Sleep	☆☆☆☆☆	**Screen time**	☆☆☆☆☆
Exercise	☆☆☆☆☆	**Relax and recharge**	☆☆☆☆☆
Social engagement	☆☆☆☆☆	**Healthy eating**	☆☆☆☆☆

What is one change you could make to improve your mental wellbeing?

Brainstorm some ways that could help you or a classmate manage heightened or strong emotions.



Create your own list of mood boosting activities.

1. .....
2. .....
3. .....
4. .....
5. .....
6. .....
7. .....
8. .....
9. .....
10. .....

LESSON 8: Problem Solving

LEARNING INTENTIONS	SUCCESS CRITERIA
Students will: • Learn the steps to problem-solving. • Revise key concepts from the lessons. • Create a plan for building my resilience at school.	Students will be able to: • Demonstrate the steps of problem-solving. • Recognise and explain key concepts of RIOT. • Produce a 'Student Plan' for being more resilient at school. • Complete a feedback sheet.

STEPS TO PROBLEM SOLVING

- **Define the problem.**
- **Think about what you want, your goal or outcome.**
- **Brainstorm solutions.**
- **Select a solution that best fits your goal and is likely to work.**
- **Implement the solution.**
- **Evaluate the results.**
- **If the problem isn't resolved, go back to the beginning.**

EXERCISE PRACTISE YOUR PROBLEM SOLVING

Use the problem solving steps from above to come up with a solution to this problem.

Scenario 1

My friend is angry with me because I didn't meet her at lunch to work on our project, which is due in two days. I planned to go, but I had to help a student who was injured and then forgot to meet her because I was still in the sick bay. When I realised, I rushed to the library, but she had already left. I feel upset because I didn't mean to ignore her and I'm worried about our friendship and the project. I should talk to her, explain what happened, and apologise for not letting her know. Then I should ask if we can meet again soon so we can finish the project together.

Define the problem

What is the solution

Scenario 2

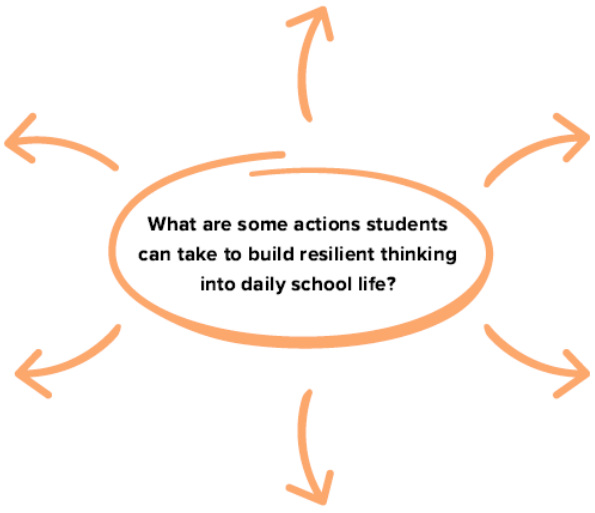
I have a problem because I agreed to help my grandparents on Saturday morning, but a friend has invited me to go to Dreamworld all day with free tickets. I really want to go, but I don't want to let my grandparents or my mum down, especially since my grandma is preparing lunch for me and I can't help them on Sunday because of a soccer gala day. I feel stuck because I don't want to disappoint anyone. I think I should talk to both my grandparents and my friend as soon as possible, explain the situation honestly, and try to find a solution that keeps my promise while being fair to everyone.

Define the problem

What is the solution

EXERCISE **STUDENT ACTION PLAN**

Brainstorm actions students can take to build resilient thinking into daily school life.



TRED RESILIENCE CHECKLIST

Self Check
Have I reflected on my initial thoughts?

Describe Feelings
Have I used accurate language to describe my feelings or problem?

Problem Solving Strategies
Have I tried to use my problem solving strategies?

Self Calming & Relaxation Techniques
Have I tried to use my self calming and relaxation techniques to calm myself?

Support Each Other
Have I asked another student to support me in using my strategies?

Seek Support
Have I sought support from my class teacher, Year Advisor or the Wellbeing Team?

"Focusing on our Future"

Does this list include all the important actions students in our school can take to be more resilient?

Is there anything in there that can be added?

REFLECTION

Write three key ideas you have learnt from the RIOT lessons.

1. .....

.....

2. .....

.....

3. .....

.....

What is one action you can take today to improve your mental wellbeing?

_____

_____

_____

Write a message to yourself to remind you about how you can be a more resilient person.

_____

_____

_____

_____

_____

_____

_____

_____

_____

_____

_____

_____

_____



Hand model of the brain find-a-word

B	R	D	I	L	R	U	O	Y	P	I	L	F	T
G	R	S	E	L	C	S	U	M	E	S	N	E	T
M	R	A	L	A	E	S	L	A	F	A	L	S	L
E	F	I	L	R	U	O	Y	E	V	A	S	I	C
R	E	A	F	I	G	H	T	L	E	D	M	D	P
M	S	A	R	E	H	T	A	E	R	B	N	L	R
F	M	M	R	E	L	A	X	E	I	R	I	E	E
R	A	Y	E	A	F	T	F	C	F	E	A	D	F
E	R	G	L	A	S	L	S	T	Y	G	R	O	R
E	T	D	R	D	F	Y	I	L	S	N	B	M	O
Z	P	A	M	T	S	B	L	G	C	A	E	D	N
E	A	L	P	T	D	E	R	S	H	D	L	N	T
C	R	A	E	H	E	A	P	F	L	T	L	A	A
F	T	M	A	I	C	O	R	T	E	X	Y	H	L

SMART PART

LIMBIC SYSTEM

TENSE MUSCLES

RELAX

FLIGHT

PRE-FRONTAL

FALSE ALARM

HAND MODEL

FLIP YOUR LID

FIGHT

AMYGDALA

SAVE YOUR LIFE

DANGER

BRAIN

FREEZE

BELLY

CORTEX

BREATHE